

The shortcuts the pros actually use

5 Claude Code Hacks.

Five small habits that turn Claude Code from a chatty assistant into a real workhorse. Each one takes under 5 minutes to set up.

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READ TIME

5 minutes

Hack 01 · /resume

Shut your laptop, come back tomorrow, and Claude picks up exactly where you left off — instead of starting from zero.

```
claude --resume
```

Gives you a picker list of every past session. For the most recent one without picking:

```
claude --continue
```

Hack 02 · Custom Slash Commands

Stop retyping the same instructions. Drop a markdown file in **.claude/commands/** (project-only) or **~/.claude/commands/** (everywhere) — the filename becomes the command, and **\$ARGUMENTS** passes in whatever you type after it.

EXAMPLE

security.md with a review checklist becomes `/security <PR url>` — a custom review that runs the same way every time.

Hack 03 · Hooks

Fire a shell command automatically on four events: **PreToolUse** (before a tool call — block risky writes), **PostToolUse** (after — auto-format, lint, test), **Stop** (turn ends — send yourself a notification), **UserPromptSubmit** (every prompt — inject context or log).

```
"PostToolUse": [{"matcher": "Edit|Write", "hooks": [{"command": "prettier --write $CLAUDE_FILE_PATH"}]}
```

Hack 04 • MCP Servers

Connect Claude to the tools you already run — Notion, Slack, Linear, GitHub, your database. One config line per app.

```
claude mcp add notion --url https://mcp.notion.com/sse
```

Start with three, not thirty: Notion (read/write your second brain), Slack (summarize threads, send updates), and GitHub (open PRs, review diffs).

Hack 05 • Parallel Subagents

The Task tool spawns smaller agents that run at the same time, each with its own context window. What used to take 25 minutes serial takes 5 minutes parallel.

TRY IT

"Spawn 5 subagents in parallel to research these tools: [X, Y, Z, A, B]. Each reports pricing, free tier, best use case, biggest weakness. Return a comparison table."

Also useful for multi-file refactors (one agent per module) and running unit/integration/lint tests all at once.

Do This Today

- 01 Run `claude --resume` right now and see what's sitting there.
 - 02 Create one custom slash command — even a silly one.
 - 03 Add the prettier hook above and watch your next edit auto-format.
 - 04 Install one MCP server for a tool you already use daily.
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— NeuraFlow Academy